

AN AFRICAN ARODE

The first humans originated in Africa 1.7 million years ago and spread out from here to the rest of the world. Today, with 14 percent of the world's population spread across 53 countries, the African continent houses countless different peoples speaking many different languages, living among some of the most spectacularly varied wildlife, vegetation, and scenery on the planet.

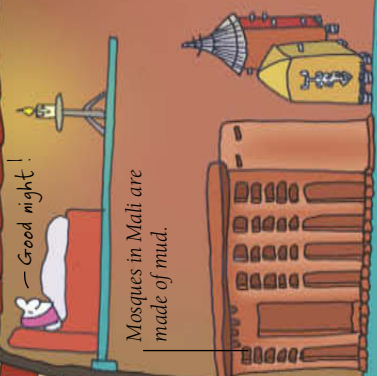
You're a big fish.

It's flying high!



— Good night!

Mosques in Mali are made of mud.



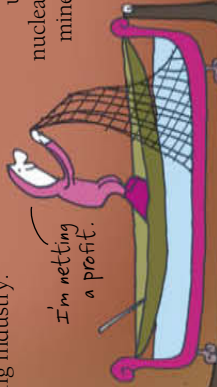
Mali

The Dogons of Mali build distinctive tall, thin houses high up on a cliff for defense purposes.

Mauritania

Lying to the north of the Niger Valley on the Atlantic coast, Mauritania has a major offshore fishing industry.

I'm netting a profit.



Burkina Faso

Humped zebu cattle, goats, sheep, and camels are the main animals kept by Burkina's farmers.



A calabash made from a gourd is carried on the head by Fulani tribesmen in Burkina.



The Niger Valley

The Niger River rises in the central highlands of Guinea and flows northeast before taking a sharp turn to head south through Nigeria and empty out into the Gulf of Guinea. The third longest river in Africa, the Niger, like the Nile, provides important transportation links and is an important water source for the countries that line its banks.

Niger

Large reserves of uranium, the fuel used to make nuclear power, are mined in Niger.

Powerful stuff.



The Maghreb

Isolated from the rest of Africa by the Sahara, the countries of the Maghreb are among the richer African nations, helped by tourism in Morocco and Tunisia, and oil and gas in Algeria.

Phosphates

Morocco possesses about one-third of the world's reserves of phosphates, used to make fertilizers.

Souk and ye shall find...



Atlas Mountains

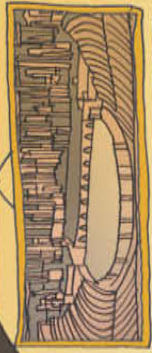
Morocco

The Kingdom of Morocco is famous for its historic towns, such as Fez and Marrakech, and their bustling souks, or markets.

Tunisia

Popular with Europeans, Tunisia is an alluring destination on the Mediterranean coast for hot beach vacations.

The ruined Roman town of Leptis Magna



Libya

Located between the Maghreb and Egypt, Libya was once a colony of the Roman Empire.

Wish you were here?



Algeria

Algeria is a major exporter of natural gas to Europe and has reserves of oil, iron ore, and phosphates.



Egypt

The legendary Sphinx guards the pyramids of ancient Egypt at Giza.



Sudan

Khartoum, Sudan's capital, sits on the banks of the Nile where its two tributaries meet.



The Nile Valley

A lifeline for the area, with many millions of people living along its banks, the Nile has two main tributaries—the White and Blue Niles—which meet in Sudan, and then flow north through Egypt to the Mediterranean Sea.

Suez Canal

The 100-mile- (160km-) long Suez Canal connects the Mediterranean and Red Seas—a useful route for sailing between Europe and Asia.



The Nile River

An essential water source for the locals, the Nile is also a major transportation highway.

Sudan's crops

Cotton, gum arabic from Acacia trees, and sesame seeds are just some of Sudan's crops.

Top crops!

